

Vula Sponsorship Targets

Vula Careers — Sponsorship Target List

Important caveat before using this list: the institutions and companies below are real, well-known South African organisations selected because their profile plausibly fits sponsoring Vula (they recruit the age/interest group Vula reaches, or have relevant CSI/Skills Development budgets). I have **not** verified current staff names, job titles, emails or phone numbers for any of them — those change often and guessing them would be actively misleading. For each target, this list tells you **which department to approach and why**; you'll need to find the actual current contact via the institution's website, LinkedIn, or a warm introduction before reaching out.

Prioritised for the **Cape Town-first launch** (per the current rollout plan), with national targets flagged for Phase 2+.

How to prioritise within this list

1. Start with organisations that can decide and sign quickly (private colleges, smaller corporate CSI budgets) to get 2–3 **Founding Sponsors** live fast.
2. Run university/large-corporate outreach in parallel — their sales cycles are longer (procurement, committee sign-off), so start early even though they'll close later.
3. Use the first signed sponsor as a case study to accelerate every conversation after it.

A. Universities (Cape Town first)

Institution	Why they fit	Who to approach
University of Cape Town (UCT)	Top-tier, high applicant volume, strong recruitment/marketing function	Student Recruitment / Marketing & Communications office
Stellenbosch University	Large Western Cape applicant base, strong faculties across RIASEC types (engineering, agri-science, arts)	Student Recruitment office
University of the Western Cape (UWC)	Strong access/transformation mandate — likely receptive to a low-cost, wide-reach awareness channel	Marketing & Institutional Advancement
Cape Peninsula University of Technology (CPUT)	Practical/technical programmes match “R”/“C” profile learners well	Student Recruitment / Marketing

Phase 2+ national universities: University of Johannesburg (UJ), Wits, University of Pretoria (UP), Tshwane University of Technology (TUT), University of KwaZulu-Natal (UKZN), Durban University of

Technology (DUT), North-West University (NWU), Rhodes University, Nelson Mandela University (NMU), University of the Free State (UFS).

B. Private Higher Education & Colleges

Generally faster-moving decision-makers than public universities — good early targets.

Institution	Notes
Rosebank International (formerly Rosebank College)	Multiple campuses incl. Cape Town; strong recruitment marketing spend already. Advtech rebranded May 2026 — rosebankcollege.co.za now redirects to rbi.ac.za .
Emeris (formerly Varsity College)	Cape Town/Newlands campus. Varsity College, Vega, MSA and Monash merged into a single “Emeris” brand in 2026.
Boston City Campus	Wide national footprint, budget-conscious learners — good fit for accessible messaging
Damelin	National footprint, broad course range across RIASEC types. Registration contested as of early 2026 — DHET issued a notice of intent to cancel registration (Dec 2025), Damelin was appealing as of March 2026. Verify current status before investing outreach effort here.
CTU Training Solutions	IT/business focus — good fit for “I”/“C” profile learners
Eduvos	Strong digital-native marketing culture already, likely receptive to a WhatsApp channel
Emeris (formerly Vega)	Creative/design/marketing — good fit for “A” profile learners. Now part of the same Emeris merged brand as Varsity College above.
AFDA	Film/media/performance — strong fit for “A” profile learners

Approach: Marketing or Student Recruitment department at each brand (private college groups often centralise marketing across campuses, so one conversation may cover multiple cities).

C. TVET Colleges (trade/artisan pathways — under-marketed, strong fit for “R”/“C” learners)

Institution	Notes
False Bay TVET College	Cape Town metro
College of Cape Town	Cape Town metro, multiple campuses
Northlink TVET College	Cape Town metro

Phase 2+: expand to TVET colleges in Johannesburg (South West Gauteng TVET), Durban (Coastal KZN TVET, Umfolozi TVET), Pretoria (Tshwane North/South TVET).

Approach: Marketing office or Principal’s office directly — TVET colleges typically have smaller, more accessible marketing teams than universities, and often welcome free/low-cost awareness channels since their marketing budgets are usually thin.

D. Corporate CSI / Skills Development / Bursary Programmes

These budgets often sit under **Corporate Social Investment (CSI)**, **Skills Development** (a B-BBEE scorecard element), or a dedicated **Foundation**. Pitch: sponsoring Vula is measurable, low-cost pipeline-building for their existing bursary/learnership programme, and counts toward Skills Development spend.

Company	Why they fit
Sasol	Large, long-standing bursary programme (engineering/science); strong CSI structure
Anglo American	Bursary + graduate programmes; mining/engineering pipeline needs
Investec	Well-known bursary programme (Investec Bursary), strong CSI/ESG reporting culture
Allan Gray	Allan Gray Orbis Foundation — entrepreneurship-focused, strong fit for “E” profile learners
Old Mutual	Foundation with education-focused CSI spend
Sanlam	Foundation with bursary/education programmes
Nedbank	Nedbank bursary programme + strong CSI reporting
Standard Bank	Bursary programmes across commerce/IT/engineering
Absa	Bursary + graduate programmes
FirstRand/RMB/FNB	Various foundation and bursary initiatives
MTN	MTN Foundation — youth/education focus, digital-native brand fit
Vodacom	Vodacom Foundation — youth/education/digital skills focus
Discovery	Discovery Foundation (though historically health-professional focused — check current scope)
Transnet	Transnet Foundation/bursary — engineering/logistics pipeline
Eskom	Bursary programme — engineering pipeline (subject to budget constraints; verify current status)
Naspers/Prosus	Strong digital/tech-skills CSI angle
Woolworths / Pick n Pay	Retail/supply-chain learnership pipelines, strong existing CSI/ESG reporting culture

Approach: CSI/Corporate Affairs department, or the Foundation directly if the company runs one as a separate entity (many of the above do). Skills Development / Transformation office is the alternate entry point if CSI isn’t the right fit.

E. Professional Bodies & SETAs

Less likely to pay a sponsorship fee directly, but worth engaging as **awareness partners** — they have a mandate to grow pipeline into their sector and may co-promote or connect you to member companies with CSI budgets.

Body	Sector
SAICA	Accounting/CA(SA) pipeline
ECSA	Engineering pipeline

Body	Sector
merSETA	Manufacturing/engineering/motor trades — strong TVET/artisan overlap
INSETA	Insurance sector
BANKSETA	Banking sector
W&RSETA	Wholesale & retail sector
CATHSSETA	Tourism/hospitality sector

F. Bursary Aggregators & Youth-Focused NGOs (partnership, not necessarily paid sponsorship)

Good for co-marketing and distribution rather than direct sponsor revenue — they reach the same learners and may value a free, effective tool to recommend.

Organisation	Notes
Studytrust	Bursary/mentorship NGO
Ikusasa Student Financial Aid Programme (iSFAP)	Financial aid pipeline for missing-middle students
FundiConnect	Bursary-matching platform — potential referral/integration partner

Suggested outreach sequence

1. **Week 1–2:** Cape Town private colleges + TVET colleges (fastest to close) — aim for 2–3 signed Founding Sponsors.
2. **Week 1–2 (parallel):** Open conversations with UCT/Stellenbosch/UWC/CPUT recruitment offices and 3–4 corporate CSI contacts — expect longer lead times, so start the clock early.
3. **Week 3–6:** Use the first signed sponsor's early usage numbers as social proof in every subsequent pitch.
4. **Month 2–3:** Expand the same sequence to Johannesburg/Pretoria, then Durban, following the city-by-city rollout in `MARKETING_PLAN.md`.